

Public Companies: GLP-1 / Obesity Drug Supply Chain

From drug makers through peptide manufacturing, delivery devices, and telehealth distribution

Context: 2026 is the acceleration phase of this market. Novo Nordisk won first FDA approval for an oral GLP-1 pill (Wegovy tablet) in December 2025; Eli Lilly's competing oral orforglipron is expected to follow within weeks, creating a two-player oral race. GLP-1 penetration remains low (~7% of diabetes patients, ~2% of the obese population), leaving enormous runway. November 2025 agreements between the Trump administration and both Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly cut monthly GLP-1 prices significantly, reshaping the economics for every company below.

1. Market Leaders (Approved Drugs)

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Novo Nordisk	NVO	Ozempic, Wegovy (semaglutide); first-mover with FDA-approved oral GLP-1 pill	Oral Wegovy tablet launched Jan 2026, manufactured at a North Carolina site that received a \$4.1B investment; submitted a 7.2mg high-dose subcutaneous Wegovy application; acquired Akero Therapeutics to expand pipeline into MASH
Eli Lilly	LLY	Mounjaro, Zepbound (tirzepatide); orforglipron, the first small-molecule oral GLP-1 for obesity	Orforglipron FDA approval anticipated Q1 2026, setting up a two-player oral GLP-1 race with Novo; building new orforglipron plant in Huntsville, AL
Pfizer	PFE	Developing its own oral GLP-1 candidates	One of several major pharma names positioning for the oral-formulation phase of the market alongside smaller biotechs
Amgen	AMGN	MariTide, a monthly (rather than weekly) injectable GLP-1/GIP candidate	Differentiated dosing-frequency approach positioning it as a potential later entrant with a convenience edge

2. Clinical-Stage Challengers

Smaller biotechs with no approved GLP-1 product yet, but pipeline assets that could differentiate on efficacy, dosing, or oral convenience -- and that are frequently discussed as acquisition targets.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Viking Therapeutics	VKTX	VK2735, a dual GLP-1/GIP agonist in both injectable and oral formulations	Polymarket prices a pre-2027 acquisition at ~25.5% implied probability; 17 Buy ratings vs. 2 Holds; consensus price target \$92.72 vs. shares trading under \$33
Structure Therapeutics	GPCR	Aleniglipron, an oral small-molecule GLP-1 agonist; also developing an oral amylin agonist	Positive Phase 2b data (11.3-15.3% placebo-adjusted weight loss, no plateau); Phase 3 program planned for H2 2026; \$1.5B cash runway through end of 2028

3. Peptide Manufacturing & CDMOs

The upstream bottleneck: synthesizing GLP-1 peptides at commercial scale is difficult and capital-intensive, making contract manufacturers essential capacity partners even for the largest drugmakers.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
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Lonza Group	SWX: LONN	Major global CDMO with large-scale peptide manufacturing capacity	Core beneficiary of the broader CDMO capacity expansion wave alongside CordenPharma and Samsung Biologics
Samsung Biologics	KRX: 2 07940	Korean CDMO expanding into peptide/GLP-1 manufacturing capacity	Part of the broader Asia-based capacity buildout responding to GLP-1 demand

Note: two of the most important CDMO names in this space are not independently public -- CordenPharma (privately held, ~\$1B invested in GLP-1 peptide capacity since 2024) and Catalent (acquired by Novo Holdings for \$16.5B, closed end-2024, with three fill-finish sites transferred directly to Novo Nordisk). Both are worth tracking qualitatively even though they can't be screened as tickers.

4. Delivery Devices, Packaging & Fill-Finish

Every injectable GLP-1 requires sterile vials, stoppers, syringes, or autoinjector pens -- a components layer directly analogous to your semiconductor packaging list.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
West Pharmaceutical Services	WST	Vial stoppers, seals, and containment components for injectable drugs	Core beneficiary of injectable GLP-1 volume growth as a critical containment-components supplier
Stevanato Group	STVN	Glass vials, syringes, and drug containment/delivery systems	GLP-1 revenue grew more than 50% in 2025; continued capacity investment at Fishers, IN and Latina, Italy sites for syringe production
Gerresheimer	XTRA: GXI	Glass vials and pharma packaging, with a growing devices segment	Tracking multiple GLP-1 packaging contract wins described as a multi-billion-dollar opportunity; expanding North American capacity

Note: McKinsey projects GLP-1 autoinjector demand alone will create a substantial new market for device technology, primary containment components, and raw materials by 2028 -- oral formulations (already ~30% of the split per Stevanato) require an entirely different, packaging-light supply chain, so this category's mix will shift as pills gain share.

5. Telehealth & Direct-to-Consumer Distribution

The access/distribution layer -- increasingly important as employer coverage for GLP-1s narrows and patients seek alternate paths to the drugs.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Hims & Hers Health	HIMS	DTC telehealth platform bundling provider access, consultations, and pharmacy fulfillment for GLP-1 and other specialties	2025 revenue \$2.35B (up from \$1.5B); 2.5M subscribers; 2026 guidance \$2.7-2.9B; now offers all FDA-approved GLP-1s (not just compounded); faces new price-cut competition from Ro and Amazon One Medical

Note: this category carries real regulatory risk -- Hims faced scrutiny in early 2026 over its compounded semaglutide model, and both Ro (private) and Amazon (via One Medical) are escalating price competition, which could pressure margins across the whole DTC telehealth category, not just one name.

Categories Worth Adding

- **Downstream/Secondary Effect Companies** — GLP-1 adoption has documented ripple effects on adjacent industries: sleep apnea device makers (ResMed), bariatric surgery device makers, and packaged food/snack companies have all been discussed as potential long-term beneficiaries or losers; this is a distinct, more speculative research thread from the direct

supply chain above.

- **Biosimilar/Generic Entrants** — semaglutide patents expire in 2026 in large markets (China, India, Brazil, Canada, Turkey), representing ~40% of the global population; biosimilar makers positioned for these markets are a distinct, higher-volume/lower-margin opportunity not covered above.

- **Raw Material/Excipient Suppliers** — upstream amino acid and excipient suppliers feeding peptide synthesis are under-covered here, similar to the materials gap flagged in your robotics and semiconductor packaging lists.

Generated July 10, 2026. This is a disjoint reference set, not a ranked or filtered list.